

A Kriya Sequence

???? ?? ??? Kriy? Yoga (Six Essential Practices)

ORIGINS

This sequence draws on the Kriya Yoga material developed at the Bihar School of Yoga by Swami Satyananda Saraswati, close enough in spirit and technique to be taught honestly under that source. The full traditional system holds around seventy kriyas, of which some twenty are commonly taught, organised in three stages: an initial set of pratyahara kriyas (withdrawing the senses inward), followed by dharana kriyas (concentration), and closing with a single dhyana kriya (meditation proper). What follows are six essential practices from the early part of that sequence, its working foundation.

WHAT IT IS FOR

Each kriya moves awareness along a fixed inner pathway, up the front of the body through a series of contact points, and back down the spine through the chakras themselves, using breath, sound, or pure attention as the vehicle. The sequence is deliberately cumulative: each practice builds directly on the one before it, first establishing the pathway itself, then adding sound, then breath alone, before moving into the combined locks and postures of the later practices. The aim throughout is the same one Zhan Zhuang and the Healing Sounds share in their own idiom: to draw awareness inward and settle it, rather than let it stay scattered at the surface.

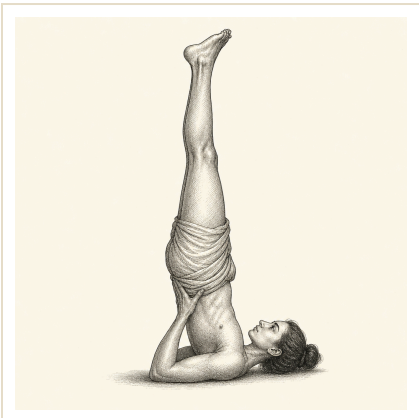


K1 Vipareeta Karani Mudra

The Inverted Psychic Attitude, first of the kriyas

PRATYAHARA

INVERSION



POSTURE

An inverted position, legs raised overhead, the gaze turned up toward the feet, the whole body relaxed once the shape is found.

EXECUTE

With Ujjayi breath, awareness begins at the navel center and rises with the inhale to the throat center, held there briefly. The exhale is released freely, without tracking a return path, before awareness comes back to the navel to begin the next round. Begin with a handful of rounds and let the number grow slowly over months, never forcing past the point of comfort or head pressure.

PURPOSE

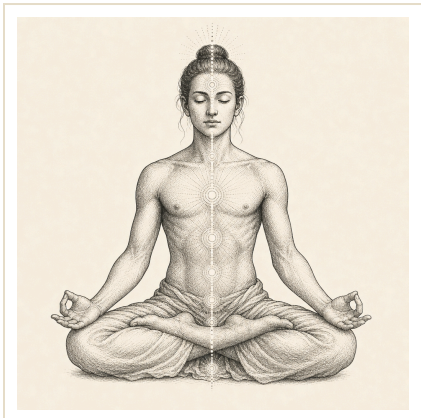
Reverses the ordinary downward, outward drift of energy and attention. Traditionally described as balancing the breath evenly between the two nostrils, a sign, in this system, of a settled and receptive nervous system.

K2 Chakra Anusandhana

Rotation of Awareness Through the Chakras

PRATYAHARA

MAPPING THE PATHWAY



POSTURE

Seated, spine upright, breath left natural rather than controlled.

EXECUTE

Awareness travels from the base center up through each chakra and its corresponding front-body contact point in turn, reaching the crown, then descends back down through the spine itself to the base, naming each center, silently, as it is reached.

PURPOSE

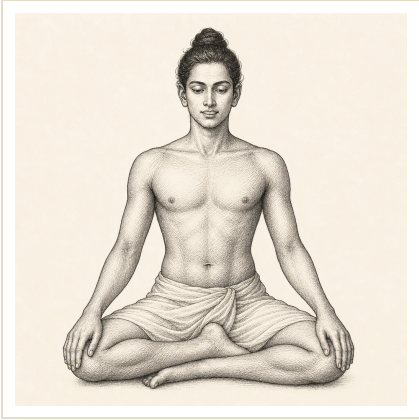
This is the map before the journey: it familiarises the practitioner with the ascending and descending inner pathway that every kriya after it will use. Once that pathway is genuinely known in the body, this practice can be shortened or set aside, its job is orientation, not depth.

K3 Nada Sanchalana

Movement of Sound Consciousness

PRATYAHARA

SOUND



POSTURE

Seated in Siddhasana rather than Padmasana, easier on the knees over long, cumulative practice, eyes open, tongue resting curled toward the soft palate, breath in Ujjayi throughout.

EXECUTE

Building directly on Chakra Anusandhana, awareness rises through the same front-body pathway on the inhale, holds briefly at the crown, and then descends the spine on a long, sounded "Om" as the breath releases.

PURPOSE

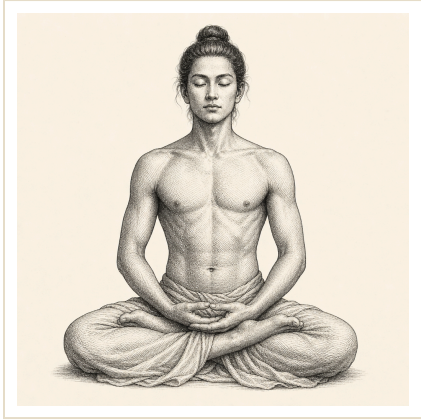
Brings the sound current into the same pathway already mapped, deepening the sense of the ascent and descent as one continuous, connected loop rather than a series of separate points.

K4 Pawan Sanchalana

Movement of Breath Consciousness

PRATYAHARA

BREATH ALONE



POSTURE

Seated, continuing directly on from Nada Sanchalana without a break.

EXECUTE

The same ascending and descending pathway is now carried by breath alone, with neither name nor sound attached to each point, awareness simply rises with the inhale and descends with the exhale.

PURPOSE

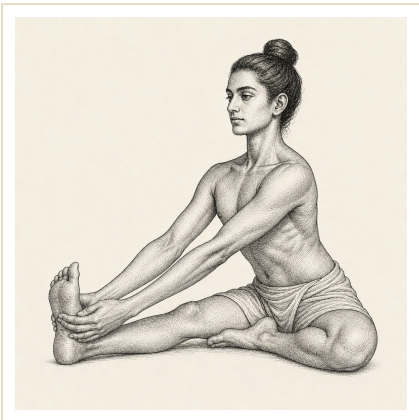
Strips away the scaffolding of the previous two kriyas, naming, then sound leaving pure breath as the vehicle for the same movement of consciousness. A refinement, not a new pathway.

K6 Maha Mudra

The Great Attitude

DHARANA

MUDRA & BANDHA



POSTURE

Seated, one leg extended forward, the other heel drawn in and pressed into the perineum, both hands holding the extended foot, spine long.

EXECUTE

The throat lock is applied together with a held inward breath, gaze steadied at the brow point, awareness gathering at the base of the spine before beginning to rise.

PURPOSE

One of Hatha Yoga's classical ten mudras, said to draw prana upward from the lower centers of the body and stabilise it there, a foundation for the more combined work of the kriya that follows.

K7 Maha Bheda Mudra

The Great Piercing Attitude

DHARANA

THREE BANDHAS COMBINED



POSTURE

Builds on Maha Mudra's seated shape, with an added forward fold toward the extended foot.

EXECUTE

With the breath held outside the body, awareness moves in turn between three points , the tip of the nose, the navel, and the perineum, while all three bandhas are held together, then released in a set order before the next round begins.

PURPOSE

Said to "pierce" through the base center, opening the way for energy to ascend through the chakras above it, one of the practices a student is expected to bring real steadiness to before moving further into the sequence.

PRACTICE NOTES

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- These practices are cumulative and sequential, each one assumes real familiarity with the pathway and breathwork of the ones before it. They are not meant to be learned out of order.
- Round counts build slowly over months, not weeks. Starting low and increasing gradually is the traditional guidance throughout, not a beginner's concession.
- The later practices. Maha Mudra and Maha Bheda Mudra in particular, combine breath retention with physical locks and should only be taught to students already steady in basic pranayama and bandha work.

SEQUENCE AND ATTENTION

- Across all six, the underlying instruction is the same: a fixed inner pathway, travelled with full attention, using whichever vehicle, breath, sound, or pure awareness, the particular kriya asks for. Nothing here is meant to be rushed; each round is a complete pass, not a step toward finishing.

SUITABLE FOR

- This sequence is intermediate to advanced practice and assumes prior grounding in seated posture, pranayama, and basic bandha work. Inverted postures and breath retention are not appropriate for students who are pregnant or managing high blood pressure, glaucoma, or cardiac conditions.